

Nature Video Diary

Video 1: I'm Ritik Sarraf, a student taking PHIL 3140. I'm currently near Bromfield area and I will be discussing about the value of the pond and its authenticity. Before starting off, I would like to introduce to the place where I'm right now. This video part 1 will specifically cover the aspects that determine the value and authenticity of the pond in the form of questionnaire. These questions will mainly reflect the ideas and concepts from the faking nature article and will further provide with arguments and criticisms to Robert Elliot's point of view. Starting with Whether the value of the pond in its original form still considered valuable so called (untouched by humans). In fact, does it show that being untouched by humans (meaning, its form of originality) automatically makes it more valuable? The trash that exists inside the pond, water seems unclear, eutrophication, algae bloom, are those really increasing the value of the pond when left at it is (untouched) and without any human intervention. If the restoration has to be taken in place to restore the pond (that might include but not limited to cleaning the water inside the pond), removing the trash/garbage from it and also evacuating the aquatic lives (fishes, etc.) with appropriate steps taken to ensure utmost safety of aquatic lives. This definitely requires the human intervention and will affect its originality. But the important question to ask ourselves is that How the restoration will end up affecting the value of the pond? Will it increase or decrease the value of the pond? A positive mindset and intention to create a pond better for the surroundings that includes (for example: wildlife, aquatic lives, insects, birds, plants, phytoplankton's, etc.) how will this end up affecting its value. I will also be talking about the pond elsewhere that feels identical to where I'm right now but that one does have clean water, no trash or garbage inside, unlikely any algae bloom (or eutrophication) and both are in its original form (untouched by humans) will this still reflect the same sense of authenticity because both ponds look identical. This is my nature video diary part 1.

Video 2: So, this is my another day of recording Nature Diary video part 2. I will be answering the questions based on my previous recording. So, when we talk about value in itself, it comes from what its purpose (or meant for) not solely about its existence or history? According to Elliott, the untouched nature helps retain the authenticity and that reflect its true value. But, this claim feels like one viewing it from an idealistic view as it assumes that there still exists completely untouched nature but in reality, human activities, pollution and carbon footprint it has created including global warming has nearly affected the entire ecosystem in someways or the other. So, in reality the idea of pure nature might not really exist any longer. Therefore, it does require the need for restoration. In this case, restoring the pond itself can help support the additional wildlife, creating favorable environment for aquatic lives inside the pond, removing algae bloom and garbage might have ease of oxygen exchange in between the pond and the atmospheric air, cleaner water provides better ambience, and its natural beauty can still be retained even after restoration, employing sustainable practices. Even if restoration might not be perfect but the important value that it creates shall not be ignored. It helps protect the ecosystem and support in flourishing biodiversity. Even if restoration isn't perfect but it still holds a value and is proven to create meaningful experience for humans, wildlife, birds and others that rely on. In this case, restoration includes human intervention is meant to support the process of restoring while maintaining safe and sustainable practices to clean the pond, support the evacuation of aquatic lives if necessary, including other plants and wildlife. It will definitely increase the value of the pond as restoration is seen as a responsibility to repair the harm that has led to pond's current situation. If we continue to believe that restored environment isn't as valuable, then it might lead to ignorance from the reality that undermines its current situation of the pond. This might bring severe damage to the pond ecosystem if not restored on time.

Video 3: Good Afternoon, and this is the last portion of the recording Nature Diary video part 3. I will be discussing about the positive intentions that we as humans hold onto and how it relates to restoration of the pond. As I have mentioned earlier that there is rare to find ecosystem that still remains natural or untouched by humans. With that being said, we humans as moral beings shall not assume that restoration cannot be effective or further degrade the ecosystem. In fact, restoration could be seen as positive intention that plays key role in providing moral responsibility to humans to repair environmental damage. A lot of environmental harm involves human activity, so restoration can be a possibility to fix it. This is a criticism to Elliott's point of view as he didn't much consider the fact that humans do hold moral responsibilities that could support to fix the environmental degradation. For example, If a restored pond could support aquatic lives and helps the environment in the same way as a natural one, and still has real value. So from this perspective, focusing only on authenticity might ignore the actual benefits that the pond ecosystem is capable of providing post-restoration. Secondly, Elliott portrays that people want real nature to validate the authenticity. This can be compared with two identical ponds at different places but one is clean and another has (garbage, dirty water, and algae bloom) similar to where I'm right now. If the dirty pond is being restored to make it look clean. Therefore, Elliott describes this case where visitors think they're experiencing real nature, but it's actually fake or restored. His point is lacking about the experience that make people feel that restored pond can still have all the values that natural pond have it. So, It is important to notice that if something looks and feels the same, then it has the same value but if the other pond would still remain dirty and if none would have care for it to restore then definitely its value would have been quite lower than natural pond.

Lastly, Restoration is definitely a possible way to raise the lost value of the pond. Although, it is imperfect and involves human intervention but for the long term it is quite beneficial as it prevents from further environmental degradation. This helps clearly define that restoration is a positive human action and holds moral responsibilities.